

Uniform & Dress Code Policy

Issue Date	Review Date	Version
November 2024	November 2029	7

Purpose

The aim of the policy is to set out the expected standard of dress for all Trust colleagues whilst on duty and travelling to and from work.

Who should read this document?

This policy must be read by all colleagues.

Key Messages

This Policy set out the expected standards of dress which ensures that the three main criteria outlined by the Department of Health, are met:

1. Patient Safety
2. Public Confidence
3. Colleague comfort

Accountabilities

Production	Richard Maguire
Review and approval	JSNC
Ratification	Director of People
Dissemination	Director of People
Compliance	Chief Nurse and Director of Integrated Clinical Professions

Links to other policies and procedures

[Infection Prevention and Control Framework](#)
[Health and Safety Policy](#)
[Equality, Diversity and Human Rights Policy](#)
[Control of Smoking Policy \(Staff\)](#)
[Hand Hygiene Guidance](#)
[Severe Weather SOP](#)
[Conduct Policy](#)
[NHS National Menopause guidance](#)

Version History

2.1	November 2008	Amended in line with Policy for Development & Management of Trust-wide policy and procedural documents
3.1	March 2009	Updated in line with 'bare below the elbows' requirements
4.1	March 2011	Trust commitment to valuing people amended in line with Equality Act 2010. Electronic policy paths updated
4.2	June 2011	Review date extended
4.3	March 2012	Review date extended
5.1	May 2012	Approved by JSNC
6	October 2017	Approved by JSNC
7	November 2024	Policy review and update by Professional Leadership Team

Equality, diversity, and inclusion is at the heart of the NHS strategy and for UHP this means ensuring we create an equitable organisation for colleagues, patients, and visitors. Our inclusion agenda recognises that everyone matters, as well as understanding that there are times when people, particularly those from protected groups (defined by the Equality Act 2010 - age; disability; gender reassignment; marriage and civil partnership; pregnancy and maternity; race; religion or belief; sex; sexual orientation), may face unfairness and discrimination.

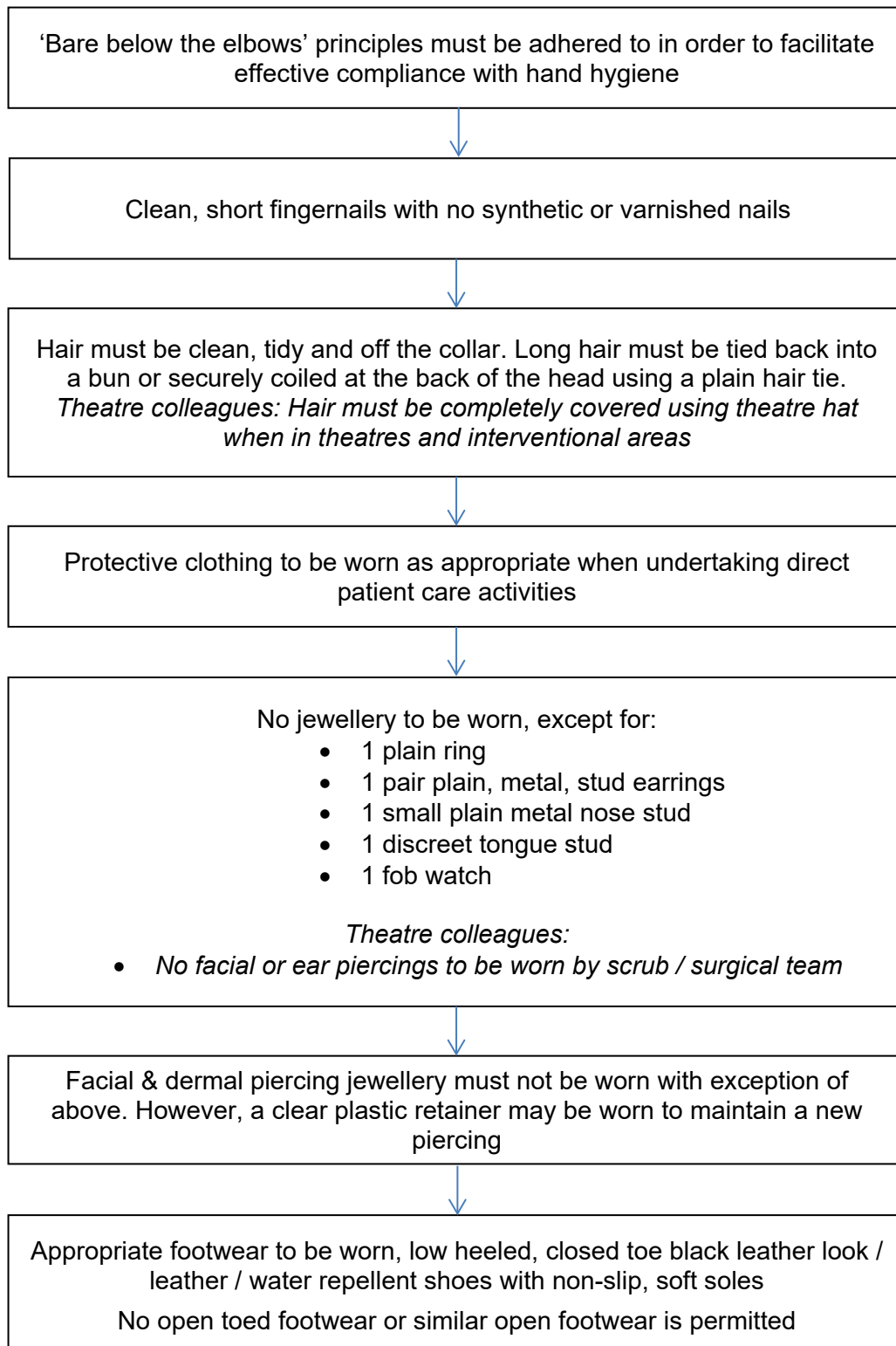
We have a moral responsibility to work in a way that creates fairness as well as a legal and public sector equality duty which we take very seriously. We will always aim to create policies and practices that eliminate workplace discrimination and health inequalities, as well as strengthening our relationships within the community and with our colleagues who may identify with one or more protected groups.

A diverse workforce improves the experience of our patients and creates an environment where everyone belongs and feels included. UHP recognise that we all play a part in providing exceptional care to patients as well as showing kindness and compassion to patients and colleagues.

An electronic version of this document is available in the Document Library. Larger text, Braille and Audio versions can be made available upon request.

Summary

This policy outlines the expectations that all colleagues will attend work suitably attired. Colleagues working at UHP have specific responsibilities around infection prevention and control and health and safety. Therefore, all colleagues must adhere to the following for the duration of their shift when engaging in direct patient care activities.



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1 Introduction

This policy applies to all University Hospitals Plymouth NHS Trust colleagues, including those with honorary contracts, contractors directly linked with healthcare provision, NHSP colleagues, agency colleagues, military colleagues, visiting professionals, locums and volunteers. For the purposes of this policy the term 'colleagues' applies to all those listed above.

This policy sets out standards for all colleagues and specific standards for both uniformed and non-uniformed colleagues directly involved in the delivery of patient care. In order to comply with this policy, uniformed colleagues involved in patient care should have enough sets of uniform sufficient for a daily change to facilitate good practice in the areas of infection prevention and control and health and safety ([Health and Safety at Work Act, 1974](#)).

Adherence to the principles of this policy is important for both colleague and patient safety. Failure to do so may result in formal management action under the conduct policy if deemed appropriate.

The Trust operates a 'bare below the elbows' policy for all clinical colleagues and for those who enter clinical areas, except where Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) rules apply.

The implementation period for colleagues to align to this Uniform Policy is 3 months from the last approval date.

2 Purpose

The aim of the policy is to set out the expected standard of dress for all Trust colleagues whilst on duty, whether uniform or non-uniform. This ensures that the three main criteria, outlined by the Department of Health ([NHS Employers, 2020](#)), are met:

1. **Patient Safety** - to protect the patient whilst they are receiving treatment and to protect the employee, their family and the community.
2. **Public Confidence** - a professional appearance with a corporate identity encourages and fosters public confidence in the health service regardless of whether colleagues wear a uniform or their own clothes and identifies the colleagues readily and with consistency of identification to patients, relatives, visitors and other disciplines whether in the hospital or in the community.
3. **Colleague comfort and safety** – as far as possible, subject to the requirements above, colleagues should feel comfortable in their uniforms / clothing, whilst offering a protection to colleagues by ensuring that uniform and non-uniform codes adhere to health and safety principles and guidelines. This includes being able to dress in accordance with their cultural practices where possible.

The *Uniform and Dress Code Policy* sets out the standards and image which the Trust wishes to convey.

Colleagues - For the purposes of this policy only the term 'colleagues' applies to employees, contractors, NHSP workers, agency workers, military workers, visiting professionals, locums and volunteers.

Clinical Colleagues – colleagues who are required to work in an area with patients or who come into direct contact with patients and their environment as part of their role.

Non-Clinical – colleagues who do not work routinely in a direct patient facing role.

Theatre Environment / Interventional Areas – areas of the hospital defined by the Association of Perioperative Practice (AfPP) as being those '*utilised immediately before, during and after the performance of a clinical intervention or clinically invasive procedure*'.

Role of the Chief Executive

The Chief Executive has overall responsibility for the health, safety and welfare of the workforce. Through delegated responsibility to the Chief Nurse and Director of Integrated Clinical Professions and Director of People, the Chief Executive will ensure there is a system in place for establishing and maintaining this policy and for meeting all statutory requirements and adhering to guidance issued in respect of the procedural document.

Role of Managers

Managers must ensure that the Trust's *Uniform and Dress Code Policy* is implemented and adhered to within their area of responsibility and ensure the colleagues they manage are aware of the policy.

Managers must:

- Maintain a safe and healthy environment where uniform or dress code is appropriate for the duties being undertaken including the use of personal protective equipment / health and safety equipment.
- Provide an initial set of uniforms is ordered dependent on job role, hours worked etc. Replacement uniforms are provided as required and in agreement with the line manager and colleague, including provision of uniform for other areas of work as required.
- Address any concerns raised by a colleague where they believe that their personal requirements or circumstances are not being met in relation to this policy thereby avoiding any discriminatory practices. The line manager should meet with the colleague (where relevant supported by the People Advisory Team) and, if appropriate, trade union representation and Occupational Health.
- Take action where a colleague does not comply with the dress code, appearance or uniform requirements set out in this policy, with reference to the Conduct Policy.

Role of Colleagues

All colleagues are responsible for:

- Complying with this and any other associated policies and procedures.
- Always maintaining standards of dress and personal appearance appropriate to their staff group and job role.

- Informing their line manager in a timely manner should their uniforms need replacing.
- Discussing with their line manager any adjustments that may need to be accommodated
- Checking with their line manager if they are unsure how this policy may or may not apply.

5 Equality & Diversity

This policy applies equally to all colleagues ([Equality Act, 2010](#)). Whilst University Hospitals Plymouth NHS Trust recognises the diversity, cultural and religious beliefs of its employees the health, safety, security and infection control of patients and employees is paramount. This means that whilst the Trust will respect an individual's cultural / religious dress requirements and accommodate health and disability it may not be possible to accommodate these requirements in order to ensure compliance with health and safety regulations, security issues (such as to confirm a colleagues identity on their ID badge) and infection control considerations ([NHS Improvements, 2020](#)).

All individuals will be treated in a fair and equitable manner recognising any special needs of individuals where adjustment may need to be made. No colleague will suffer any form of discrimination, inequality, victimisation, harassment or bullying as a result of implementing this policy.

For colleagues undergoing gender reassignment or the menopause, the People Advisory Team will provide guidance in relation to matters concerning work wear and / or uniforms.

6 Personal Protective Equipment

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) that has been issued by the Trust for health and safety reasons must be worn in the way it was intended to be used. Colleagues issued with PPE or clothing for their safety as part of their role must ensure it is worn, stored, used, cleaned, maintained, serviced and disinfected, or disposed of appropriately and in accordance with the manufacturer's recommendations ([Personal Protective Equipment Regulations, 2015 and Control of Substances Hazardous to Health \(COSHH\) 2002](#)).

7 'Bare Below the Elbows' Requirements

The Trust's 'bare below the elbows' requirements apply to all colleagues working in or visiting a clinical environment to administer direct patient care, and includes nurses, medical, dental, therapy and pharmacy colleagues, hotel services colleagues and volunteers. The only exceptions are where PPE rules apply or for religious reasons where colleagues wish to keep their forearms covered. In these instances, colleagues should ensure that full or three-quarter sleeves are not loose or dangling and able to be rolled or pulled back up the arm and secured in place for hand washing and direct patient care activity. Alternatively, disposable over-sleeves can be used and discarded in the same way as disposable gloves. Strict adherence

to washing hands and wrists must be observed before and after use. ([NHS Improvements, 2020](#); [NHS Improvement 2019](#))

Hands and arms up to the elbow/mid forearm must be free of clothing, jewellery and watches, including smart watches. Healthcare colleagues should ensure that their hands can be decontaminated throughout the duration of clinical work by:

- Being 'bare below the elbow' when delivering direct patient care ('Hands on' or face-to-face contact with patients)
- Removing wrist and hand jewellery, except for a metal band ring
- Making sure that fingernails are short (where the nail is not seen when the hand is turned palm side up), clean and free of nail polish
- Covering cuts and abrasions with waterproof dressings

The Trust requires colleagues working in clinical areas to wear short sleeves / rolled up sleeves and **no** wrist watches or jewellery should be worn (except for one metal band ring as described above) below the elbows. Fob watches may be worn instead of wrist watches without affecting patient safety.

The rationale behind bare below the elbows is to facilitate effective hand decontamination to reduce the risk of cross infection through harbouring harmful organisms ([Hand Hygiene Guidelines](#)).

8 Identification (ID) Badge

A Trust issued photo ID badge verifies a colleague's authenticity, stating their name and job title. Colleagues must wear their ID badge in a visible position whilst at work / on duty. Colleagues may be challenged if their ID badge is not visible and persistent offenders will be reported to their line manager / security if they do not have it on their person. Where a colleague refuses to give their details, they will be immediately reported to security.

Whilst not on duty when, away from Trust premises, the ID badge should be removed or covered for personal safety reasons.

Colleagues who wear lanyards should ensure the lanyard can be laundered regularly as part of uniform or work clothes and has 3 break points.

One or two of the following other badges can be worn where the badge can be cleaned as regularly as your uniform:

- Badge of Professional Organisation or Trade Union as appropriate
- Veteran / Reservist badge
- Approved National Campaign badges, worn at the time of the campaign as appropriate
- Badges awarded to colleagues under local recognition schemes, e.g. excellence awards, as appropriate.

In addition to the above, colleagues can also wear their 'Hello, my name is' badge.

9 Personal Hygiene

All colleagues are required to maintain a high level of personal hygiene and appearance.

10 General Information

All uniformed colleagues are expected to wear their designated uniform as appropriate. Clinical and non-clinical colleagues who do not wear uniform are expected to adhere to the dress code at all times when at work.

The following clothing items are not to be worn by any colleague working for UHP:

- Casual or high fashion trousers, such as ripped trousers, track suit bottoms, leggings, jeggings, wet look or sports shorts
- Low waistband trousers or shorts showing the abdomen and / or lower back
- Cropped tops, showing the abdomen and / or lower back
- Strapless, revealing or scooped, off the shoulder tops / dresses
- Very short skirts / dresses which are above mid-thigh
- Denim including jeans (any colour)
- Any garment worn where material touches / drags on the floor
- Casual / sports jumpers
- When in a clinical setting, loose clothing such as ties (but not bowties), shawls and capes that could come into contact with patients or bedside equipment.

Uniform is provided by the Trust for use on duty and remains the property of the Trust at all times and are to be returned to your line manager when leaving the Trust (Managers to refer to the [Managers Exit Checklist](#)). Colleagues will be provided with an adequate number of uniforms designed to meet infection prevention and control and health and safety requirements.

Plain tights / stockings must be worn (black for nursing colleagues) unless as outlined in Section 13.

Hoodies, cardigans and fleeces as part of a uniform outfit must be plain and dark in colour. These must not be worn when attending to patients or undertaking clinical activities.

Uniform belts and buckles may be worn around uniforms apart from during direct clinical care and patient moving and handling activities. The belt should be cleaned at the same frequency as uniforms.

Vests / undergarments worn under uniforms must be clean, short sleeved and must not be visible.

Shoes must be well fitting and offer sufficient protection, low heeled, closed toe black leather look / leather / water repellent shoes with non-slip, soft soles. No open toed footwear or similar open footwear is permitted. Crocs / Theatre clogs if worn must have back strap on the heel in place at all times. Shoes should be in good, clean condition.

11 Travelling in Uniform

Uniforms can be worn outside of the Trust when travelling to and from work and when colleagues feel safe to do so. Colleagues must ensure that ID and name badges **are not visible** to the public outside of Trust premises, such as when using public transport.

Where colleagues smoke in a public place, outside of Trust grounds, they should ensure that their uniform is covered and ID badge not visible such that individuals are not identifiable as colleagues of the Trust. Please refer to the [Control of Smoking Policy \(Staff\)](#) for further information.

It is **not acceptable** for colleagues to wear uniform or ID badges when visiting food or entertainment establishments, public houses, bars or other similar areas external to the Trust premises. These rulings are made for the safety and security of all colleagues, to minimise the risk of cross infection and prevent the potential for adverse public perception and comment. Additionally, non-uniformed clinical colleagues providing direct clinical care are advised to follow the principles of changing out of work wear before visiting the above establishments.

Colleagues wearing green theatre scrubs must change into and out of uniform at work. Green theatre scrubs **must not** be worn outside of Trust premises.

Requests to wear uniform outside of Trust premises for formal occasions or where promoting the Trust must be authorised by your Line Manager.

12 Changes to Uniform Policy in Extreme Weather Conditions

During the months of June, July, August and September the Trust has agreed for colleagues to wear tailored knee length shorts, with colour in keeping with uniform if worn, providing there are no Health and Safety risks. Nursing colleagues will not be required to wear tights during the months of June, July, August and September.

In circumstances outside of the above months where the Meteorological Office issue an amber or red Heat-Health Alert due to excessive heat temperatures, colleagues can wear tailored knee length shorts as above and nursing colleagues will not be required to wear tights during this time. Guidance will be communicated via the Daily Email.

Heat-Health Alerts can be found here: <https://ukhsa-dashboard.data.gov.uk/weather-health-alerts/heat/south-west>

13 Laundry Guidance

Uniforms should be washed separately from any other items in a washing machine at the hottest temperature suitable for the fabric (Department of Health, DoH - 2020).

Non-uniform colleagues should aim to ensure that items of clothing can be washed at a temperature of 60°C for at least 10 minutes in order for thermal disinfection to be achieved.

Alternatively, clothing must be washed at the hottest possible temperature the fabric will withstand. Hand washing is ineffective and therefore not acceptable. (For colleagues who launder their Trust uniforms, HMRC tax relief is available on the [gov.uk](https://www.gov.uk) website).

Laundered wet clothes should be dried quickly or tumble dried and ironed.

Colleagues within specific areas where scrubs / uniforms must be laundered by specialist companies will be informed by their line manager if this applies to them.

14 Hair and Hair / Head Accessories

All staff must have hair that is clean, neat and tidy and where hair is longer than shoulder length must be off the shoulder and coiled, or in a bun at the back of the head at all times on shift.

Fringes must be above the level of the eyes and if longer, tied back.

Wigs / toupees must be secured to ensure they do not fall off and washed as frequently as normal hair.

Use of hair dye is an individual choice, and the Trust is conscious of a colleague's wish to maintain individuality. However, colleagues are requested to be mindful of displaying an appropriate professional image.

Where headscarves are worn for religious or health purposes, colleagues must ensure that the flow of the garment does not interfere with work practice. The garment must be changed daily to minimise cross infection.

Facial hair must be clean, shaped and neatly trimmed. However, if for religious / cultural reasons, the beard must not be cut, it should be tied and rolled to a short length using a cord in the manner traditional to that religion. Colleagues involved in the care of patients that require the use of Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) such as FFP3 face masks may be asked to clean shave facial hair, in order to ensure safe and appropriate fitting of protective devices, in line with [HSE guidance](#).

15 False Eyelashes

False eyelashes and eyelash extensions are prohibited for all staff involved in patient care or work on clinical areas at any time, as these can pose an infection control risk.

16 Jewellery

Colleagues should ensure permitted jewellery is kept to a minimum. Non-uniformed, non-clinical colleagues should keep rings to a minimum as it is important to maintain good handwashing practices as outlined in the UHP Hand Washing Guidelines.

In line with being bare below the elbow, wrist watches or other wrist accessories must not be worn by colleagues (clinical and domestic) where you have contact with patients during your shift.

Earrings are to be restricted to small, round metal stud earrings only, worn in the ear lobe, daith (ear's inner most cartilage fold) and helix (upper ear cartilage). Stretchers in ears must have clear retainers and clear/skin tone-coloured caps following stretching.

No earrings are permitted within theatres.

Facial piercings:

- Tongue piercing – a discreet tongue stud / bar may be worn
- Nose piercing – discreet nose piercings may be worn if they do not interfere with the colleagues' role for H&S or Infection Prevention and Management. Please discuss with your line manager if unsure.

Other than those mentioned above, facial piercings must not be worn. However, a clear plastic retainer can be worn for new piercings. For certain groups of colleagues (clinical and non-clinical) where PPE is required as part of their role, additional rules will apply to abide with relevant Health and Safety regulations.

No necklaces or wrist bracelets are to be worn by colleagues working in clinical settings for the duration of their shift other than for reasons indicated below.

Colleagues where it is required or who choose to wear a religious symbol may do so provided they are discreet and comply with infection prevention and health and safety policies. Religious bracelets can be worn, but must be loose enough that they can be pushed up and secured at the elbow to allow efficient hand decontamination during clinical care / patient contact.

If a colleague is required to wear a medical identification / alert tag, it is recommended that this is worn as a necklace rather than a bracelet with suitable risk assessment. Where colleagues feel comfortable, that colleagues are informed of any medical issues in case of an emergency.

17 Tattoos

Colleagues are requested to be mindful of displaying an appropriate professional image. New tattoos must be covered with a waterproof dressing until they are healed.

Colleagues that receive patient, relative, visitor or colleague complaints about their tattoo may be asked to cover it whilst at work whilst any complaint is considered. However, the covering

of the tattoo must not contravene the bare below the elbow principle in a clinical area where this principle is required.

18 Standards for Non-Uniformed Colleagues

Colleagues who wear their own clothes rather than a uniform must ensure they portray a professional image at all times, i.e. trousers / skirt / dress and formal shirt / blouse.

As ties can act as a transmitter of infection, ties must not be worn in the clinical setting.

Make-up and Nails

Make-up should be discreet. Nails must be clean, short and neatly manicured. Nail extensions, acrylic nails, false nails, nail jewellery or nail products e.g. nail varnish are not permitted by any colleague working in or visiting clinical areas or colleagues who work in food preparation areas, as these pose an infection control risk (Hand Hygiene Guidelines).

Footwear

Footwear must be well fitting and offer sufficient protection, low heeled, closed toe leather look / leather / water repellent footwear with non-slip, soft soles. No open toed footwear or similar open footwear is permitted. Crocs / Theatre clogs if worn, must ensure that the back strap on the heel is in place at all times.

Colleagues whose role includes visiting clinical areas must abide by these further rules in addition to those laid out in the above sections.

19 Standards in Perioperative (Theatres) or Interventional Areas

Theatre wear will be standard green colour throughout all theatres and interventional areas in UHP. Theatre wear will consist of trousers and a top which are specifically designed for theatre use. Scrubs must be in good condition and removed from circulation if damaged. All surgical / theatre scrubs should be laundered in the healthcare setting and not taken home.

In the event of individual colleagues developing an allergy or sensitivity to hospital detergents, a clean set of theatre attire may be taken home and laundered. To avoid any misunderstanding, this must be discussed and documented with the line manager who will seek advice from Infection Prevention and Control.

Any theatre attire that becomes stained or contaminated must be changed as soon as possible and placed in the appropriate laundry bags.

All colleagues leaving the operating theatre must remove disposable PPE – i.e. surgical gowns, masks, gloves and place in clinical waste in the operating theatre at the end of each surgical procedure.

On non-clinical duties colleagues are required to remove hats, theatre footwear, masks and PPE and wear a cover-up gown, this includes visiting shops on Trust premises.

Warming jackets may be used to cover scrubs when on clinical duties around the trust e.g. attending pharmacy.

Warming jackets should not be worn in the operating theatre or other perioperative areas. In exceptional circumstances, if the ambient temperature drops, a warming jacket may be worn at the discretion of the practitioner-in-charge or line manager of the operating theatre. (However, in this situation, sleeves must be pushed up to ensure effective hand decontamination). Surgical gowns MUST NOT be worn as a warming jacket.

Under no circumstances should theatre attire (clothing, footwear and headwear) be worn off the hospital site and outside any of the hospital buildings. Scrubs should be stored in dedicated cupboards / shelves and must not be kept in lockers or offices or taken home. Colleagues should place dirty and soiled theatre scrubs in a green linen skip.

All colleagues visiting theatres MUST change into theatre green scrubs when entering perioperative and interventional areas.

Footwear

Footwear that has been provided by the Trust must be kept solely for theatre use.

Colleagues are permitted to purchase their own footwear, providing it conforms with the same standard as theatre issue footwear. Theatre boots or clogs should provide protection, able to be decontaminated and provide antistatic properties in line with BS EN ISO 20347 (BSI 2004) – this must be checked by the line manager and documented prior to purchase and use.

Colleagues are responsible for maintaining their footwear, which must be free from contamination and cleaned frequently, using appropriate decontamination methods and PPE.

Clogs must be worn with the heel strap supporting the ankle to reduce the risk of injury.

Visitor's footwear – refers to any person who is not a permanent member of the perioperative team visiting the clinical area. Visitors will be issued with clogs which must be returned on their departure.

All theatre footwear must be plain in colour and labelled with an individual's name.

Head Wear

All colleagues must wear a clean theatre cap when in the operating theatre and adjacent rooms. Where theatre colleagues use their own reusable caps, a clean cap must be worn each session, with caps washed in line with section 14.

The purpose of wearing a hat is to cover the hair, both at the side, ears and nape of the neck; Long hair must be neatly tied back and off the collar, before donning the hat. Colleagues working in perioperative clinical areas other than theatres, must wear long hair neatly tied back and off the shoulders. Please see section 15 for additional guidance.

Colleagues with facial hair should wear a Surgeons Hood, particularly if they are a member of the scrub team. Muslim women can either use the orthopaedic hood, single use disposable hijabs or wear a dedicated clean headscarf laundered in line with Section 14.

Headwear must be donned before scrub suits, to avoid contaminating the suit.

Headwear must be changed daily and in the event of it becoming soiled, during the shift.

Headwear must be removed when leaving the theatre department. Colleagues may wear their own cotton hats but must be of a single block colour indicating their staff group as set out above. Colleagues must wear a clean hat for each session which has been laundered to the required specification set out in section 14.

It is acceptable to wear the hood style hat that covers both hair and neck, and this may be worn over another head covering worn for religious or cultural reasons, so as to obscure the hair completely.

Jewellery

Wearing of jewellery in the perioperative environment is in line with the trust guidelines in Section 16 except for the immediate scrubbed team who will not wear any facial/ear piercings or rings.

20 Maternity Uniforms

Colleagues who are required to wear a uniform will be provided with a maternity uniform when required.

21 Failure to Comply

In most situations, issues of non-compliance with this policy can be resolved by the line manager speaking informally to the colleague and reminding them about the requirements of this uniform and dress code policy. However continued failure to comply with this policy may result in formal action and be dealt with in line with the Trust's Conduct Policy.

22 Overall Responsibility for the Document

The Senior Management Team and the Director of People in conjunction with the JSNC Policy Subgroup is responsible for ratifying this document. The Director of People has overall responsibility for the dissemination, implementation and review of this policy.

23 Consultation and Ratification

The Director of People is responsible for ratifying this document and has overall responsibility for the dissemination, implementation and review of this policy.

This policy will be reviewed by the Professional Leadership Team and Policy Subgroup of the Joint Staff Negotiating Committee and will be signed by the staff side chair and the Director of People.

This policy will be reviewed on the date specified at the beginning of the document and the policy will be revised as and when necessary.

24 Dissemination and Implementation

Following approval and ratification by the appropriate group, this policy is being rolled out across the Trust.

Publication of this policy will be publicised in IG StaffHub Page, and it will be available electronically on SharePoint Trust Documents.

25 Monitoring Compliance and Effectiveness

The People Directorate will be responsible for monitoring compliance with this policy through comprehensive advice and supporting guidance documents.

26 References and Associated Documentation

HSE (1974) *The Health and Safety at Work Act*. Available at: <http://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1974/37/contents>. (Last accessed: November 2019)

HSE (2015) *Personal Protective Equipment at Work*. Available at: <https://www.hse.gov.uk/pubns/priced/l25.pdf> (Last accessed: November 2019)

HSE (2002) *Control of Hazardous to Health Regulations*. Available at: <http://www.hse.gov.uk/nanotechnology/coshh.htm>. (Last accessed: November 2019)

HSE (2010) *Equality Act*. Available at: <http://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2010/15/contents>. (Last accessed: November 2019).

NHS Employers (2018) *Dress Codes and Discrimination*. Available at: <https://www.nhsemployers.org/retention-and-staff-experience/diversity-and-inclusion/policy-and-guidance/religion/dress-codes-and-discrimination>. (Last accessed: November 2019)

NHSE/I (2020) *Uniforms and Workwear: Guidance for NHS Employers*. Available at: <https://www.england.nhs.uk/wp-content/uploads/2020/04/Uniforms-and-Workwear-Guidance-2-April-2020.pdf> (Last accessed: Dec 2022)

NHS Menopause guidance [NHS England » Supporting our NHS people through menopause: guidance for line managers and colleagues](#)

Dissemination Plan

Appendix 1

Core Information				
Document Title	Uniform and Dress Code Policy			
Date Finalised	November 2024			
Dissemination Lead	People Partnering Team			
Previous Documents				
Previous document in use?	Yes			
Action to retrieve old copies.	Will be removed and replaced with this version			
Dissemination Plan				
Recipient(s)	When	How	Responsibility	Progress update
All Trust Staff	November 2024	SharePoint	People Directorate	

Review		
Title	Is the title clear and unambiguous?	x
	Is it clear whether the document is a policy, procedure, protocol, framework, APN or SOP?	x
	Does the style & format comply?	x
Rationale	Are reasons for development of the document stated?	x
Development Process	Is the method described in brief?	x
	Are people involved in the development identified?	x
	Has a reasonable attempt has been made to ensure relevant expertise has been used? IC and OH&WB	x
	Is there evidence of consultation with stakeholders and users?	x
Content	Is the objective of the document clear?	x
	Is the target population clear and unambiguous?	x
	Are the intended outcomes described?	x
	Are the statements clear and unambiguous?	x
Evidence Base	Is the type of evidence to support the document identified explicitly?	x
	Are key references cited and in full?	x
	Are supporting documents referenced?	x
Approval	Does the document identify which committee/group will review it?	x
	If appropriate have the joint Human Resources/staff side committee (or equivalent) approved the document?	x
	Does the document identify which Executive Director will ratify it?	x
Dissemination & Implementation	Is there an outline/plan to identify how this will be done?	x
	Does the plan include the necessary training/support to ensure compliance?	x
Document Control	Does the document identify where it will be held?	x
	Have archiving arrangements for superseded documents been addressed?	x
Monitoring Compliance & Effectiveness	Are there measurable standards or KPIs to support the monitoring of compliance with and effectiveness of the document?	x
	Is there a plan to review or audit compliance with the document?	x
Review Date	Is the review date identified?	x
	Is the frequency of review identified? If so, is it acceptable?	x
Overall Responsibility	Is it clear who will be responsible for co-ordinating the dissemination, implementation and review of the document?	x

Core Information	
Directorate	People Directorate
Date	November 2024
Title	Uniform and Dress Code Policy
What are the aims, objectives & projected outcomes?	The aim of the policy is to set out the expected standard of dress for all Trust staff whilst on duty and travelling to and from work.
Scope of the assessment	
Collecting data	
Race	This area will be monitored through workforce data. As stated in this policy health and safety compliance will override any cultural/religious requirements and we appreciate this may have an impact and appropriate consideration will be given to individual requirements.
Religion	This area will be monitored through workforce data. As stated in this policy health and safety compliance will override any cultural/religious requirements and we appreciate this may have an impact and appropriate consideration will be given to individual requirements.
Disability	There is no evidence to show an impact in this area, however data will be monitored through workforce data reporting and analysis
Sex	There is no evidence to show an impact in this area, however data will be monitored through workforce data reporting and analysis
Gender Identity	There is currently no data collected to show the impact in this area, however, this will be monitored via feedback as appropriate.
Sexual Orientation	There is no evidence to show an impact in this area, however data will be monitored through workforce data reporting and analysis
Age	There is no evidence to show an impact in this area, however data will be monitored through workforce data reporting and analysis
Socio-Economic	There is currently no data collected to show the impact in this area, however, this will be monitored via feedback as appropriate
Human Rights	There could potentially be an impact on Human Rights due to race and religious belief requirements which are covered in those specific areas within the EIA.
What are the overall trends/patterns in the above data?	No trends or patterns identified at this stage. However, workforce data will be monitored, and any trends or patterns will be identified and appropriate actions will be put in place.

Specific issues and data gaps that may need to be addressed through consultation or further research	There is currently no data collected to monitor the impact on gender identity, socio-economic and human rights. It is recognised there will be an impact on race and religion due to the requirement to comply with health and safety regulations.
Involving and consulting stakeholders	
Internal involvement and consultation	People Partners, Senior Nursing, Trust Management, JSNC
External involvement and consultation	None
Impact Assessment	
Overall assessment and analysis of the evidence	At present whilst it is acknowledged that this policy will have an impact on race and religion, there is no anticipated negative impact as this is due to health and safety compliance. However, the workforce data that can be collected will be monitored to assess the impact.